

Q&A

Your Questions, Our Answers

Questionable licenses and truant uninstallers—all dealt with right here!

Cable Trouble

Q My system stops responding suddenly while I'm in the middle of my work. I can do nothing but restart it. After restarting, it says "DISK BOOT FAILURE: PLEASE INSERT SYSTEM DISK AND PRESS ENTER". I then have to remove the cabinet, move the cables, and restart. The system works fine for a day or two, and then it's the same thing over again.

Ashok Pothana

A Your problem is essentially a result of faulty power connectors. The fault develops with Molex connectors over a period of time, usually if they are frequently removed from and attached to devices. We advise you get the power connectors replaced as soon as possible; faulty connectors can lead to hard drive errors and eventually drive failure.

Certification Obsession

Q I have an NVIDIA GeForce FX 5200 graphics card. The drivers supplied with it are not WHQL certified. When I try to install drivers from NVIDIA Forceware versions 77.37, 93.13, and others, I see an error like "No supported drivers found compatible for your GPU."

Gaurav Warhekar



You can use unsigned drivers as long as you know where they came from

A Go ahead and install the drivers that came with your card even if they are not WHQL certified. WHQL certification is not a prerequisite for the thing to work. The driver numbers you mentioned do not support GeForce FX 5200 GPU-based graphics cards. Download the latest NVIDIA drivers for your card from www.nvidia.com if you are experiencing any issues with the older drivers.

The Mother Of All Errors!

Q When I switch on my computer, I see the following message: "Intel CPU uCode Loading Error". Please help.

Vinay Tiwari

A Your motherboard needs a BIOS upgrade. Visit the Web site of your motherboard manufacturer and download the latest BIOS for your motherboard—and also the utility to flash the BIOS. You might be able to flash your BIOS through Windows, but if it can only be flashed in DOS mode, you will need to boot using a Windows 95/98 bootable CD or disk.

Wired!

Q My friend and I have computers with Windows XP SP2, and we have the same broadband ISP. Each of us has a static IP address. How can we remotely access each other's computers?

Manan Pandya

A Windows XP has a utility, called Remote Desktop Connection, which lets you access a computer remotely. You can use it to access your friend's computer and vice-versa in the following way. First, enable Remote Desktop on both the PCs. Open System in the Control Panel and click the Remote tab. Check the box next to Allow users to connect remotely to this computer under the Remote Desktop section, and click OK. That's it; you can connect to each other's computers and view each other's Desktops.

For those who do not have a static IP, there are other ways: register for free at www.LogMeIn.com, and download and install the application on the PC that is to be accessed remotely. The host PC does not require the application to be installed; all you need to do is log on to the site and sign in. You can immediately start accessing the Desktop of the target PC. This works even if either or both of the PCs is / are behind a proxy server.

Time To Upgrade!

Q I have 3 GHz Pentium IV, a motherboard with SiS Mirage onboard graphics, 512 MB of RAM, and an 80 GB hard drive. I installed two games, *Shadowgrounds* and *Lord of the Rings* from your DVD, but when I start them up, the game window launches for a moment and closes automatically. I have Windows XP Pro SP2 and have even installed DirectX 9c.

Sameer Ahmed

A The games you've mentioned require a DirectX 9c compatible graphics card, and the SiS Mirage graphics solution won't do. Just installing DirectX 9c does not fulfil the requirements; the hardware needs to be fully compatible to be able to render the graphics in newer games. We suggest you upgrade to a newer graphics card such as the NVIDIA 8500 / 8600 series if price is of concern. If it's not, you can opt for higher-performance cards such as the NVIDIA 8800 series. You will also need to upgrade your motherboard to be able to support one of these PCIe cards, so make sure

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!